

Pea Meju R&D Fermentation Log (Draft)

"Our records become the new map of pea meju."

This log serves as valuable research data for the summer pea-meju R&D process. Rather than fixing a "correct answer," it is a journey of observing the changes that occur in each person's own environment. Please observe the meju at a set time each day and record exactly what you sense, in a relaxed manner.

Participant Basic Information

Researcher (recorder) name: _____

Region of residence: _____ City/County _____
District/Town/Township

Environmental characteristics of where I live? ☐ []

Inland/mountainous ☐ [] Urban/flatland ☐ [] Coastal area

Fermentation start date: 2026, _____ month _____ day

Meju molding size and count: (e.g., walnut-sized, approx. 18 g; total _____ pieces)

Wrapping leaves used: ☐ [] Kudzu leaf ☐ [] Cocklebur leaf ☐ []

Lotus leaf ☐ [] Mugwort leaf ☐ [] Other ()

Fermentation site environment: ☐ [] On the jang jar platform ☐ []

Balcony ☐ [] Indoors ☐ [] Other ()

Daily Observation Log (Day 1 to Day 7 after molding)

** It is best to observe at a consistent time each day (e.g., 2 PM).*

[Basic Observation Item Guide]

- Weight: Place the meju (or the entire batch of meju) on a scale and record the changing weight. (For tracking moisture evaporation.)
- Color stage: [1] Light green/green [2] Yellowish [3] Brownish → [4] White/yellow mold appears
- Aroma (smell) description: Boiled-pea smell, nutty meju smell, sour smell, musty smell, fermented-liquor smell, etc.
- Internal temperature / ambient temperature: The temperature measured by inserting a thermometer between the meju (internal temperature), and the room/outdoor temperature where the meju is placed.

[Day 1] Surface-Drying and Leaf-Wrapping Stage

Date/time: ____ month ____ day ____ o'clock | Ambient temp:
____ °C / Humidity: ____ %

Total meju weight: _____ g

Meju internal temperature: ____ °C

Visible changes (color and appearance):

Surface condition: ☐ Moist ☐ Slightly drying ☐ Firmly
dried

Meju color:

Changes detected by smell (aroma):

Notes and one-line memo: (e.g., wrapped the meju in leaves,
placed it on the jar lid, and covered it with a cotton cloth.)

[Day 2] Full Fermentation, Day 1

Date/time: ____ month ____ day ____ o'clock | Ambient temp:
____ °C / Humidity: ____ %

Total meju weight: _____ g (vs. previous day: - _____
g)

Meju internal temperature: ____ °C (check whether it rises to
36–37°C)

Visible changes (color and appearance):

Meju color change:

Surface change: ☐ No change ☐ Faint white mycelium
(mold) visible ☐ Becoming sticky

Changes detected by smell (aroma):

Insect intrusion check: ☐ No problem ☐ Fruit flies/insects
found (action: _____)

Notes and my impressions:

[Day 3] Full Fermentation, Day 2

Date/time: ____ month ____ day ____ o'clock | Ambient temp:

____ °C / Humidity: ____ %

Total meju weight: _____ g

Meju internal temperature: ____ °C

Visible changes (color and appearance):

Meju color change:

Surface mold state: [] None [] White [] Yellow [] Other ()

Changes detected by smell (aroma):

Notes and my impressions:

[Day 4] Full Fermentation, Day 3 (Fermentation Completion Stage)

Date/time: ____ month ____ day ____ o'clock | Ambient temp:
____ °C / Humidity: ____ %

Total meju weight: _____ g

Meju internal temperature: ____ °C

Visible changes (color and appearance):

Changes detected by smell (aroma):

Notes and my impressions:

[Day 5 – Day 7] Drying and Pre-Crushing Stage

Date/time: ____ month ____ day ____ o'clock

Total meju weight: _____ g (check whether it has become lighter than at the start as moisture leaves)

Final meju color and aroma state:

Crushing work (about one week later):

When you break open the meju, what is the inside like? (e.g., well-dried all the way through, slightly moist inside, etc.)

What is the cross-section color of the broken meju?

Overall R&D Reflections (Workshop Closing Survey)

If you described the final “aroma” of the pea meju you made in three words?

(e.g., nutty, cheonggukjang-like, grassy, etc.) → [], [], []

What was the most difficult thing to manage during fermentation, or the point requiring the most caution?

(e.g., ambient temperature was too low; fruit flies gathered, so a net was put over it, etc.)

Your one-line reflection on participating in this first attempt at “summer pea meju” R&D?

Naeileui Siktak (Tomorrow's Table) / mak /